

CS5351 2025/26 SemA

Modern Code Review

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Outline

- ◆ What is Code Review?
- ◆ Why do we do it?
- ◆ Code Inspection
- ◆ Modern Code Review
- ◆ Background readings
 - https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fagan_inspection
 - <https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/6606617/>
 - downloadable when connecting to the campus network
- ◆ Try a code review tool by a group of students (Ex MCR-2)

1

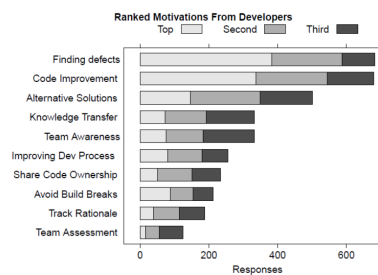
2

What is Code Review

- ◆ Performing human inspection on the source code by developers other than the author of the code.
- ◆ is a well-established software engineering practice
- ◆ aim at ***maintaining and promoting*** source ***code quality***, as well as ***sustaining*** development ***community*** by means of ***knowledge transfer*** of design and implementation solutions applied by others [12]

What is Code Review

- ◆ Performing human inspection of the source code by developers other than the author of the code.



Apart from finding bugs, code review has many other purposes: code improvement, alternative solution, knowledge transfer, team building, and so on.

Fig. 3. Developers' motivations for code review. [1]

3

4

Different Levels of Formality

- ◆ Code walkthrough
 - informal meeting where the programmer leads the review team through his/her code, and the reviewers try to identify faults
 - More effective if the programmer and reviewer are not the same person
 - Sometimes, integrate with Pair Programming
- ◆ Code Inspection
 - Formal meeting
 - Effective to find bugs in code.
 - Home Reading: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fagan_inspection
- ◆ Modern Code Review

```
bool isWin(char game[3][3]){
    bool win = false;
    if (game[0][0] == game[0][1] && game[0][1] == game[0][2] && (game[0][0] == 'X' || game[0][0] == 'O')) win = true;
    if (game[1][0] == game[1][1] && game[1][1] == game[1][2] && (game[1][0] == 'X' || game[1][0] == 'O')) win = true;
    if (game[2][0] == game[2][1] && game[2][1] == game[2][2] && (game[2][0] == 'X' || game[2][0] == 'O')) win = true;
    // column
    if (game[0][0] == game[1][0] && game[1][0] == game[2][0] && (game[0][0] == 'X' || game[0][0] == 'O')) win = true;
    if (game[0][1] == game[1][1] && game[1][1] == game[2][1] && (game[0][1] == 'X' || game[0][1] == 'O')) win = true;
    if (game[0][2] == game[1][2] && game[1][2] == game[2][2] && (game[0][2] == 'X' || game[0][2] == 'O')) win = true;
    // diagonal
    if (game[0][0] == game[1][1] && game[1][1] == game[2][2] && (game[0][0] == 'X' || game[0][0] == 'O')) win = true;
    if (game[0][2] == game[1][1] && game[1][1] == game[2][0] && (game[0][2] == 'X' || game[0][2] == 'O')) win = true;
    return win;
}

int main(){
    int i, j;
    char game[3][3] = {' '}; // Tic-tac-toe
    char player1 = 'X';
    char player2 = 'O';
    bool turn = true; // false for player 1's turn, true for player 2's turn. Player 1 first.
    cout << "X - Player 1" << endl << "O - Player 2" << endl;
    for (int n=0; n<9; n++){
        turn = !turn; // use the not-operator to change true to false or false to true.
        if (turn == false)
            cout << "Player 1: ";
        else
            cout << "Player 2: ";
        cout << "Which cell to mark? i:[1..3], j:[1..3]: ";
        cin >> i >> j;
        if (turn == false)
            game[i][j] = 'X';
        else
            game[i][j] = 'O';
        if (isWin(game)){
            cout << "Win!" << endl;
            break; // need to terminate the problem
        }
    }
    if (i==3) // all celles with i=0 to 2 have been inputted above but no winner yet
        cout << "Tie!" << endl;

    // show the game to console
    cout << game[0][0] << " " << game[0][1] << " " << game[0][2] << endl;
    cout << game[1][0] << " " << game[1][1] << " " << game[1][2] << endl;
    cout << game[2][0] << " " << game[2][1] << " " << game[2][2] << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

Code walkthrough:

isWin() aims to do what and so

Main() performs this in these few lines and that in those lines

Code Walkthrough

- ◆ Result from an old paper [21]
 - Similar to testing in effectiveness for finding bugs
 - But code walkthrough requires more human effort. Thus, less effective
- ◆ In recent years, developers have become aware of technical debts (non-bug issues), where testing is ineffective in addressing them.
 - E.g., readability, reusability, maintainability, etc.
- ◆ The remote collaboration raised from the needs of “work from home” make code walkthrough by visually impaired developers to join code walkthrough remotely. Some strategies proposed are shown on the next slide.

e.g., Code Walkthrough [22]

Table 3: Use of audio cues to convey awareness indicators in Follow mode (unless specified otherwise in the row)

Awareness Information	Non-Speech Indicator	Non-Speech Indicator Frequency	Speech Indicator	Speech Indicator Frequency	Built-in Visual Indicator
Viewpoint scrolls	Click wheel sound	Every scroll event	None	None	Screen scrolls
Scroll direction	Falling or rising tone depending on direction	When scrolling stops	None	None	Can be inferred from the scrolling viewpoint
Current Viewpoint	None	None	"Lines X to Y on screen"	When scrolling stops	Visible on screen
Cursor moves by single line to line N	Keyboard click	Every cursor move	"Line N"	1.5 seconds after cursor moves end	Cursor moves on screen
Cursor moves multiple lines to line N	Falling or rising tone depending on move direction	Every event	"Line N"	1.5 seconds after cursor moves end	Cursor moves on screen
Cursor moves by multiple lines to line N	Falling or rising tone depending on move direction	Every event	"Line N"	Every event	Cursor moves on screen
Selection	Depends on selection (key board/mouse)	Every event	"Selection on line N"	1.5 seconds after selection is made	Selection visible on screen
Edit on follower's line	Keyboard type	For every character typed	None	None	Cursor moves on screen; edits visible on screen
Edit on follower's line (Follow mode off)	Keyboard type	For every character typed	"collaborator is editing the same line as you"	As long as edits continue on the same line	Cursor moves on screen; edits visible on screen
Edit within 3 lines of follower (Follow mode off)	Proximity sound	For every character typed	"collaborator is editing nearby"	As long as edits continue on the same line	Cursor moves on screen; edits visible on screen
Follow status	Pull and push sound	When follower starts and stops following leader	"You are now following -collaborator-"	Every event	None



Code Inspection [6]

- ◆ Is a highly-structured formal process of review
 - Sometimes called as *static testing* in companies
 - Effective to find bugs and spot further process improvement
 - Decreasingly popular
- ◆ Main Ideas
 - **Pre-meeting:** Authors educate reviewers, and reviewers read/question the code from a testing angle.
 - **In-meeting:** Walk through the code (by code author) with reviewers and check against checklists. Answer questions and resolve ambiguity. Each reviewer has a predefined role assigned pre-meeting. (e.g., a focal area to check)
 - Reviewers “execute” the code in their heads
 - **Post-meeting:** Authors follow up and correct code. The moderator of the meeting verifies the required corrective actions taken properly.
- ◆ Characteristics
 - Formal, synchronous, check code, tool support is secondary, heavy-weighted ⁹

Code Inspection

- ◆ Things to check
 - Efficiency of algorithm
 - Logics and correctness of code
 - E.g., control-flow and data-flow, I/O format and order, parameters and return value types and order etc
 - Comments and consistency with code
- ◆ Develop your own checklist

MCR: Authors’ Private Materials

Tic-tac-toe (過三關) is a game involving two users. In the game, there is a 3x3 grid. The grid is initially empty. Each cell can place with the character ‘X’, the character ‘O’, or be left empty. When there is a row, a column or a diagonal all filling with the same character, then the user Wins. For instance, the diagram shows that the bottom row is all filled with the character ‘X’. So, the user for ‘X’ wins the game.



The written program is to allow two players (Player 1 and Player 2) to input the coordinates of their chosen cells in turn. After receiving each input, the program determines whether there is any winner, and if there is a winner, it outputs the message “Win!”. If there is no winner after all the 9 cells filled, output “Tie!”. Right after showing the message “Win!” or “Tie!”, it shows the whole tic-tac-toe grid and terminates the game.

MCR: Materials Authors to Pass to Reviewers

Console screen: Inputs are underlined

```
X = Player 1
O = Player 2
Player 1: Which cell to mark? i:[0..2], j:[0..2]: 0 2
Player 2: Which cell to mark? i:[0..2], j:[0..2]: 0 0
Player 1: Which cell to mark? i:[0..2], j:[0..2]: 2 0
Player 2: Which cell to mark? i:[0..2], j:[0..2]: 1 1
Player 1: Which cell to mark? i:[0..2], j:[0..2]: 2 2
Player 2: Which cell to mark? i:[0..2], j:[0..2]: 1 2
Player 1: Which cell to mark? i:[0..2], j:[0..2]: 2 1
Win!
O   X
O   O
X X X
```

Any comments/suggestions (5mins)

```
def is_win(game):
    win = False
    # Check rows
    if game[0][0] == game[0][1] == game[0][2] and (game[0][0] == 'X' or game[0][0] == 'O'):
        win = True
    if game[1][0] == game[1][1] == game[1][2] and (game[1][0] == 'X' or game[1][0] == 'O'):
        win = True
    if game[2][0] == game[2][1] == game[2][2] and (game[2][0] == 'X' or game[2][0] == 'O'):
        win = True
    # Check columns
    if game[0][0] == game[1][0] == game[2][0] and (game[0][0] == 'X' or game[0][0] == 'O'):
        win = True
    if game[0][1] == game[1][1] == game[2][1] and (game[0][1] == 'X' or game[0][1] == 'O'):
        win = True
    if game[0][2] == game[1][2] == game[2][2] and (game[0][2] == 'X' or game[0][2] == 'O'):
        win = True
    # Check diagonals
    if game[0][0] == game[1][1] == game[2][2] and (game[0][0] == 'X' or game[0][0] == 'O'):
        win = True
    if game[0][2] == game[1][1] == game[2][0] and (game[0][2] == 'X' or game[0][2] == 'O'):
        win = True
    return win

def main():
    game = [[' ' for _ in range(3)] for _ in range(3)] # Tic-tac-toe board
    player1 = 'X'
    player2 = 'O'
    turn = False # False for player 1's turn, True for player 2's turn. Player 1 first.
    print("X = Player 1")
    print("O = Player 2")
    for n in range(9):
        turn = not turn # Switch turns
        if not turn:
            print("Player 1: ", end="")
        else:
            print("Player 2: ", end="")
        print("Which cell to mark? i[1..3], j[1..3]: ")
        i, j = map(int, input().split())
        i -= 1
        j -= 1
        if not turn:
            game[i][j] = 'X'
        else:
            game[i][j] = 'O'
        if is_win(game):
            print("Win!")
            break # Terminate the game
        if n == 8: # All cells have been filled
            print("Tie!")
        # Show the game board
        for row in game:
            print(" ".join(row))

if __name__ == "__main__":
    main()
```

Modern Code Review (MCR)

- ◆ MCR is a lightweight and tool-based code review of *code change* (not the whole piece of code!)
 - is the norm for many software development projects
- ◆ Characteristics of MCR
 - Informal; tool-based logistics; asynchronous; and focused on reviewing code changes; lighter weight than code inspection
- ◆ Main Ideas
 - Author **A** makes a patch **P** on a code block **C** to address some problems and sends the patch **P** via c-channel (e.g., email, WhatsApp, Wechat, or GitHub tool) to a set of reviewers **R**
 - Each reviewer **R** evaluates **P**: either deems **P** good or rejects **P**
 - Author **A** commits **P**; post-commit reviewer by other **R**s possible.
- ◆ Authors and reviewers exchange ideas, find bugs, and discuss alternative solutions to better design the structure of a submitted code change. ¹⁵

MCR Process

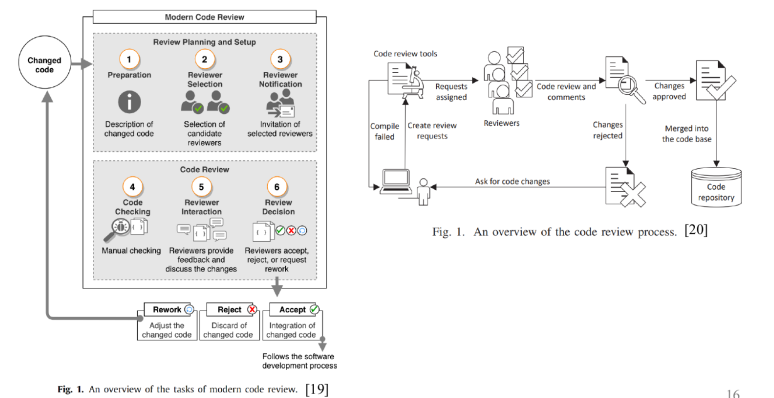


Fig. 1. An overview of the tasks of modern code review. [19]

Example [12]

Change 101781 - Merged

Implement EDP for a spark standalone cluster

This change adds an EDP engine for a spark standalone cluster. The engine uses the spark-submit script and various flags provided via cli to run, monitor, and terminate Spark jobs.

Currently, the Spark engine can launch "Java" job types (this is the same type used to submit Scala Java action on hadoop clusters). A directory is created for each Spark job on the master node which contains [jar file, the script used to launch the job, the job's output and status, and a script file containing the exit status of spark-submit, the directory is named after the submit job and the job submission is on to be kept in memory, preventing them from being lost in the help of debugging jobs.

A few general improvements are included:

- * engine.launch_job() may return updated job status
- * engine.cancel_job() may return job status and handle for job_execution_status
- * addition to job_id

It will do:

- * create a proper Spark job type (new CD)
- * make the job_id location on the master node configurable (new CD)
- * add functionality to clean up job directories on the master node (new CD)
- * allow users to pass some general options to spark-submit itself (new CD)

Partial implementation: `bin/submit spark-submit`

Change-Id: `I210a4eb75b6475494754234b40c03977E`

Owner	Trevor McKay
Reviewers	Bob, Alice, John, Rob, Edward, Sam, Ryan, Alex, Enzo, Frank
Project	5698790e3642a2b791c60203d5522816784e1
Branch	a23a4e547a43a3a3f35581880d51838f1c5585

Files	Comments
sdh/service/dep/job_manager.py	33
sdh/service/dep/job_utils.py	46
sdh/service/dep/standalone_engine.py	46
sdh/service/dep/job_utils.py	18
sdh/service/dep/standalone_engine.py	7
sdh/service/dep/standalone_engine.py	66
sdh/service/dep/job_manager.py	161
sdh/service/dep/standalone_engine.py	12
sdh/service/dep/job_utils.py	303
sdh/service/dep/standalone_engine.py	10

See next slide

Author	Alice <alice@redhat.com>
Committer	Alice <alice@redhat.com>
Commit	9d8b799b342a2b791c60203d5522816784e1
Parent(s)	a23a4e547a43a3a3f35581880d51838f1c5585
Change-Id	I210a4eb75b6475494754234b40c03977E

History

Alice Uploaded patch set 1

Bob Patch Set 1:

sdh/service/dep/job_manager.py

Line 68:

should the be grouped with

if job_info.get("status") in job_utils.terminated_job_statuses:

put in case 'status' doesn't exist?

Alice Patch Set 4:

The patch LGTM, apart from the small comment on the commit message.

One important question, though, is about the data sources. How is total and output specified for each job submitted through Spark EDP?

Spark does not support Shell for now, so I would expect only HDFS to be available.

Example [12] Expanding a file in the change

```
class FormPostTest(ObjectStorageFixture):
    @classmethod
    def setUpClass(cls):
        super(FormPostTest, cls).setUpClass()
        cls.key_cache_time = (
            cls.objectstorage_api_config.templur_key_cache_time)
        cls.templur_key = cls.behaviors.VALID_TEMPLUR_KEY
        cls.object_name = cls.behaviors.VALID_OBJECT_NAME
        cls.object_data = cls.behaviors.VALID_OBJECT_DATA
        cls.content_length = str(len(cls.behaviors.VALID_OBJECT_DATA))
        cls.http_client = HTTPClient()
        cls.redirect_url = "http://example.com/form_post_test"
```

```
class FormPostTest(ObjectStorageFixture):
    @classmethod
    def setUpClass(cls):
        super(FormPostTest, cls).setUpClass()
        cls.key_cache_time = (
            cls.objectstorage_api_config.templur_key_cache_time)
        cls.object_name = cls.behaviors.VALID_OBJECT_NAME
        cls.object_data = cls.behaviors.VALID_OBJECT_DATA
        cls.content_length = str(len(cls.behaviors.VALID_OBJECT_DATA))
        cls.http_client = HTTPClient()
        cls.redirect_url = "http://example.com/form_post_test"
```

Alice Apr 22, 2015
Should there be a default value for the cls.templur_key, or should the fixture assert if keys_set is empty? All of the tests depend on the attribute, but for whatever reason, if the X-Account-Meta-Temp-Uri-Key is not present in the headers, the attribute will not exist, and the tests will error out in an ungraceful manner.
[Review](#) [Close](#) [Delete](#)

Bob Apr 22, 2015
So the check_account_templur_keys method will first check to see if the account keys are set and if they aren't, it will set them to some defaults. If, for some reason, it fails to set them properly, keys_set should be False instead of True. So, what I will do is have an else statement here which will raise an Exception but in all likelihood it would fail in the behaviors beforehand.
[Review](#) [Close](#) [Delete](#)

```
40 @ObjectStorageFixture.required_features('formpost')
41 def test_object_formpost_redirect(self):
42     ***
```

```
44 @ObjectStorageFixture.required_features('formpost')
45 def test_object_formpost_redirect(self):
46     ***
47     ***
```

Example [17] GitHub

1. In the upper-right corner of any page, use the drop-down menu, and select **New repository**.
2. Type a short, memorable name for your repository. For example, "hello-world".
3. make any changes you need to the file.
4. decide whether to add your commit to the current branch or to a new branch.
5. Create a pull request to propose and collaborate on changes to a repository.

The first screenshot shows the 'New repository' dropdown menu in the top right corner of a GitHub page. The second screenshot shows the 'Create a new repository' form with 'Repository name' set to 'hello-world' and 'Description' set to 'My first repository on GitHub'. The third screenshot shows the 'Edit file' view of a repository with a file named 'hello-world.txt' containing the text 'I love :coffee: :pizzai:, and :dancer:.'. The fourth screenshot shows the 'Open a pull request' dialog with the 'base' branch set to 'main' and the 'compare' branch set to 'octocat-patch-1'.

Example [17] GitHub

octo-org / octo-repo Private

Code Issues Pull requests 24 Actions Projects Wiki Security Insights Settings

Conversation Commits Files changed

```
113 113 lineElements.css background-color, ''
116 116 if lineRange.length is 1
117 117     if lineRange.length is 1
118 118         $(\"\\\"#{anchorPrefix}\\\"#{lineRange[0]}\\\".css 'background-color', \"#ffe\"
119 119         + $(\"\\\"#{anchorPrefix}\\\"#{lineRange[0]}\\\".css 'background-color', \"#f8d7d7\"
120 120     else if lineRange.length > 1
121 121         i = lineRange[0]
122 122         while i <= lineRange[1]
123 123             $(\"\\\"#{anchorPrefix}\\\"#{lineRange[i]}\\\".css 'background-color', \"#ffe\"
124 124             + $(\"\\\"#{anchorPrefix}\\\"#{lineRange[i]}\\\".css 'background-color', \"#f8d7d7\"
125 125             i++
126 126     # Highlight and scroll to the lines in the current location hash.
```

24 app/assets/javascripts/github/pages/diffs/linkable-line-number.coffee

@@ -9,3 +9,27 @@

7. When you're done, click Start a review. If you have already started a review, you can click Add review comment.

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Characteristics of Modern Code Review

- ◆ Informal
 - Ad hoc group of reviewers without predefined roles, and the review process does not follow a formal procedure
- ◆ Tool-based logistics
 - Email, WhatsApp, WeChat are popular.
 - Open-source tools: GitHub, Gerrit (for Git), ReviewBoard, Phabricator
- ◆ Asynchronous
 - Authors and reviewers need not engage in the same task simultaneously (but not extensively delayed)
- ◆ Focus the review on the patch (code change, the delta)

Purposes of Reviews/Comments/Posts [1]

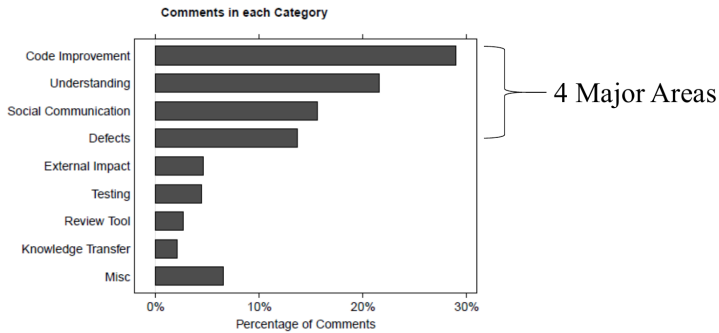


Fig. 4. Proportion of comments by card sort category.

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Understanding the Code for What? [1]

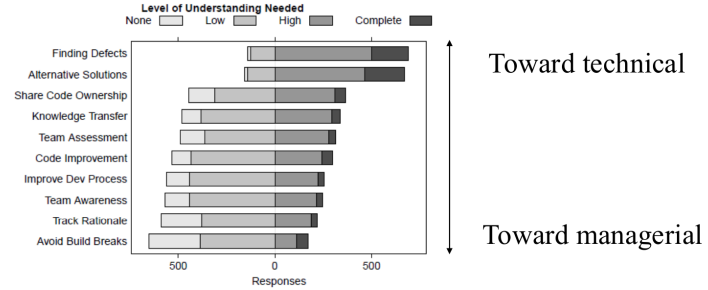


Fig. 5. Developers responses in surveys of the amount of code understanding for code review outcomes.

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Strategy to Deal with Confusion [14]

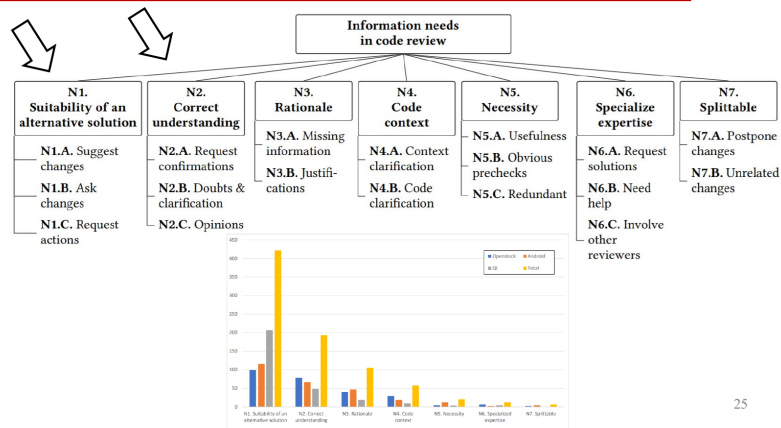
THE REASONS, IMPACTS AND COPING STRATEGIES DEVELOPERS USE TO DEAL WITH CONFUSION; IN THE PARENTHESIS ARE THE NUMBERS OF CARDS.

	Review process 8 topics (129)	Artifact 15 topics (300)	Developer 15 topics (124)	Link 9 topics (177)
	Organization of work (17)	Missing rationale (66)	Disagreement (18)	Lack of familiarity with existing code (47)
	Issue tracker, version control (7)	Discussion of the solution: non-functional (40)	Communicative intention (9)	Lack of programming skills (40)
	Unnecessary change (6)	Unsure about system behavior (37)	Language issues (2)	Lack of understanding of the problem (21)
	Not enough time (3)	Lack of documentation (29)	Propagation of confusion (3)	Lack of understanding of the change (17)
	Dependency between changes (3)	Discussion of the solution: strategy (29)	Fatigue (1)	Lack of familiarity with the technology (14)
Reasons 10 topics (507)	Code ownership (2)	Long, complex change (25)	Noisy work environment (1)	Lack of knowledge about the process (3)
	Community norms (2)	Lack of context (19)		
		Discussion of the solution: correctness (14)		
		Impact of change (11)		
		Irreproducible bug (6)		
		Lack of tests (5)		
	Delaying (31)	Better solution (1)	Decreased confidence (10)	
	Decreased review quality (11)	Incorrect solution (2)	Abandonment (6)	
	Additional discussions (11)		Frustration (5)	
	Blind approval (8)		Anger (2)	
	Review rejection (4)		Propagation of confusion (2)	
Impacts 14 topics (98)	Increased development effort (4)			
	Assignment to other reviewers (2)			
Coping strategies 13 topics (116)	Improved organization of work (5)	Small, clear changes (4)	Information requests (36)	Improved familiarity with existing code (28)
	Strategies Delaying (2)	Improved documentation (4)	Off-line discussions (12)	Testing the change (5)
	Assigning to other reviewers (1)		Providing/giving suggestions (10)	Improved familiarity with the technology (2)
	Blind approval (1)		Discussions resolution (6)	

No particularly good strategy

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What Information is Needed by Reviewers? [12]



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How about a review patch is for code refactoring?

- ◆ Industrial case study in Xerox [23]
- ◆ “coping with poor design and coding style is the main driver for developers to apply refactoring in their code changes. Yet, functional changes and bug fixing activities often trigger developers to refactor their code as well.”

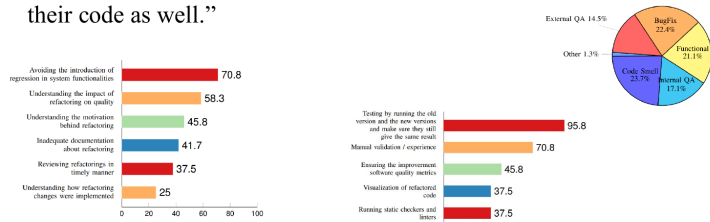


Figure (4) Challenges faced by developers when reviewing refactoring.

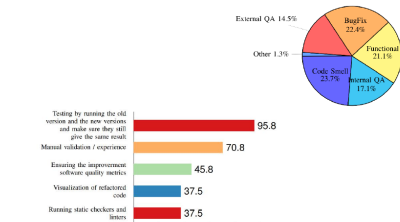


Figure (5) Mechanisms used to ensure the correctness after the application of refactoring.

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How about Knowledge Transfer?

- ◆ Does conducting more rounds of MCR improve the code quality of a developer?
 - Unfortunately, there is no evident yet both within the same project and across multiple projects. [16]
- ◆ Then, let's look at the MCR in big tech companies. See the next few slides.

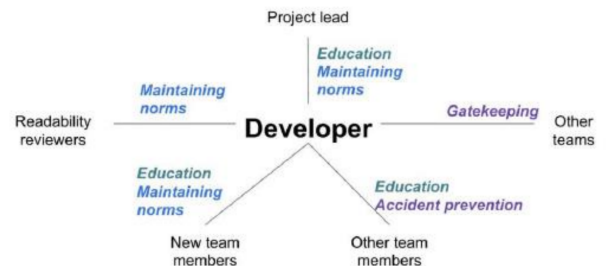
27

MCR Best Practices [1, 3, 7]

- ◆ Contemporary peer review follows a lightweight, flexible process
- ◆ Reviews happen early (before a change is committed), in time, and frequently
- ◆ Reviewers have a prior knowledge of the context and the code complete reviews quicker and provide more valuable feedback to the authors
- ◆ Change sizes are small
- ◆ Small numbers of reviewers (1 to 5 reviewers)
- ◆ Read informal posts and comments on the code and patch
- ◆ Review is not just to find bugs at group-level: problem solving (solution development), code readability and maintainability, following the norm (of the belonging company), accident prevention, gate-keeping (recall the role of moderator in code inspection?)

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MCR Best Practices [3]



- ◆ The above diagram shows the relationships between Developer (i.e., Author) and Reviewers in a code project in Google

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MCR Best Practices in Google [3]

- ◆ Suggesting Reviewers: ask persons who can serve as reviewers in turn and in round-robin manner.
 - Do not consistently overload the best persons in the team
- ◆ Perform code analysis to supplement human reviewers
 - Apply style checker, code checkers
 - E.g., Checkstyle for Java
- ◆ Review frequency: 4 hours of review (and 4 review) per week (median)
- ◆ Review speed: authors waits for 1-5 hours
- ◆ Changed code size: 1 line of code (~10%), one file (~30%), fewer than 10 files (~90%).³⁰

MCR Best Practices

- ◆ Reviewer candidates?
 - Code owner
 - Developers who made previous changes on the code
 - Developers who develop the code before (e.g., in producing the code through pair programming)
 - Experienced reviewers
 - Developers who develop similar features of the changed fragments in some other code
 - ...

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MCR Issues

- ◆ Review Quality and Code Size
 - **Reviews on code with higher complexity get fewer discussions and feedback.**
 - **Code with fewer review feedback will encounter more post-release bugs**
- ◆ Distance
 - Causing delay in the review process or leading to misunderstanding
 - Aspect 1: Geographical issue
 - Large physical distance between authors and reviewers
 - Aspect 2: Organization issue
 - Reviewers from different teams or taking different roles
- ◆ Social Interaction
 - Tone: comments with negative tones are less useful
 - Power: ask another person to change their comments. Authors unhappy
- ◆ Context
 - Misunderstanding due to mismatched expectations on the code change (e.g., nice to have vs. urgent fix, full solution vs. high level sketch)³²

Other Issues in Ineffective MCR: Anti-Pattern in MCR [18]

TABLE I: MCR anti-patterns and their associated symptoms and consequences.		
MCR anti-pattern	Symptoms	Potential Consequences
Confused reviews (CR)	- Reviewers ask question(s) about the rationale or the solution approach of the patch. - Reviewers express incertitude in review comments.	<i>Process</i>: Confusion decreases the efficiency and the effectiveness of the review [6], [10]. <i>Artifact</i>: The patch may still have poor quality after the review as reviewers may not fully understand the patch [6]. <i>People</i>: Reviewers may feel frustrated and may express negative sentiments due to the confusion [6].
Divergent reviews (DR)	- The review decisions do not reach consensus. - The review scores are diverged. - Reviewers post conflict review comments to each others.	<i>Process</i>: The divergence can slow down the integration process [16]. <i>Artifact</i>: It is correlated with negative development outcomes (i.e., patches without changing) [16]. <i>People</i>: The divergence increases contributors' likelihood of leaving the communities and lead to the poor team performance [11], [29].
Low review participation (LRP)	- The patch does not have other developers as a reviewer. - The patch receive few/short comments. - The patch does not receive prompt/timely feedback from reviewers.	<i>Process</i>: The lack of review participation has a negative impact on review efficiency and effectiveness [30]. <i>Artifact</i>: Patches with low number of reviewers can be more defect-prone [7]. <i>People</i>: The inefficient reviewer feedback could make the patch author forget the change. [5]

TABLE II: The detection results of MCR anti-patterns.			
Anti-pattern	# Instances	Kappa	Agreement
Confused Reviews (CR)	21	0.93	Perfect
Divergent Reviews (DR)	20	1.0	Perfect
Low Review Participation (LRP)	32	1.0	Perfect

TABLE III: The prevalence of MCR anti-patterns.	
Category	Count
Code reviews affected by one anti-pattern	67
Code reviews affected by two anti-patterns	21
Code reviews affected by three anti-patterns	4

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Should We Review Test Code too?

- ◆ The simple answer is “yes”, but on different focuses and less often (and review with the production code)

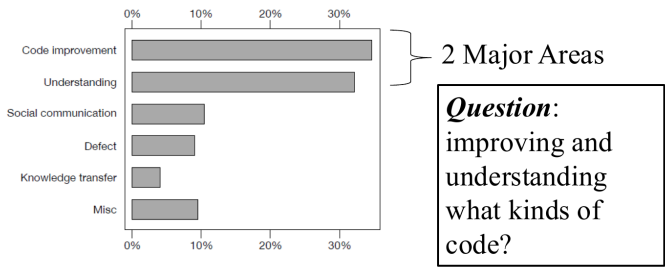


Figure 1: The outcomes of comments in code review of test files, after manual analysis in 600 comments (CL=99%, CI=5). [4]

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Understanding and Improving What Kinds of Code by Reviewing Test Code? [15]

Conducted by German researchers from 92 developers.

INTERVIEWEES' EXPERIENCE (IN YEARS) AND WORKING CONTEXT			
ID	Developer	Reviewer	Working context
P1	8	8	OSS
P2	3	3	Company A
P3	15	15	Company A
P4	10	10	Company B
P5	10	5	Company C
P6	3	2	Company D
P7	16	16	Company E
P8	4	4	Company F / OSS
P9	3	3	Company G / OSS
			Applying TDR
P1			Almost never
P2			Almost Always
P3			Almost Always
P4			Almost Never
P5			Always
P6			Sometimes
P7			Always
P8			Sometimes
P9			Never

Finding 1. In reviews in which tests are presented first, participants found significantly more bugs in test code, yet fewer maintainability issues in production code. The production bugs and test maintainability issues found is stable across the treatments.

Finding 3. Perceived problems with TDR: Developers report to (1) consider tests as less important than production, (2) not being able to extract enough knowledge from tests, (3) not being able to start a review from tests of poor quality, and (4) being comfortably used to read the patch as presented by their code review tool.

Finding 4. Perceived advantages of TDR: Developers report that TDR (1) allows them to have a concise, high-level overview of the code under test and (2) helps them in being more testing-oriented, hence improving the overall test code quality.

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Modern Code Review: In-Class Activity MCR-2

<https://github.com/marketplace/category/code-review>

- ◆ Form a group of 4-5
 - Author **A** of the code: 1 student
 - Reviewer **R**: no pre-defined role
 - Agree among members the tool for review (we use Github support)
- ◆ Timeline (in minutes)
 - 00-15: **A** prepares the patch **P** for the code **C** on Github platform, along with some explanation of the patch **P**, and notifies groupmate via the e-channel
 - 15-25: **R** reviews **P** and posts comments on Github. Also, notify via the e-channel when finishing the review
 - 15-25: **A** answers issues and provides clarifications made by **R** and revises patch **P** iteratively.
 - 25-30: **R** approves **P** and **A** applies the final patch **P'** get the final corrected code **C2**
 - 30: **A** submits the corrected **C2** with comments (images or link to the Github repository?) to Canvas Discussion for peer sharing in addition to using **C2** as a commit

Self-Study Home Exercise [no submission is needed]

- ◆ Read Ref [1]
 - Find out the methods to increase team awareness
 - On page 5, a summary from a senior developer stated five benefits of code review. What are the benefits?
 - On pages 5-6, what can a team do to increase knowledge transfer?
 - On page 7, what are the stated problems if the quality of review code is low?
 - On page 9, what are the recommendations? Do you agree?
- ◆ Read Ref [5]
 - On slide 23, what are the key features of a tool to support code reviews that the author of the Slide Presentation believes the tool to have?
- ◆ Self-Reflection
 - If your company asks you to incorporate MCR into your project but without providing addition budget (\$), what and how you implement MCR for it?
 - Distance is a major MCR issue. How does a team (with members located in different cities and probably with different culture backgrounds) do MCR?

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Home Reading

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